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Radiologic and MRI Technologists

Summary

Quick Facts: Radiologic and MRI Technologists	
2018 Median Pay	$61,240 per year $29.44 per hour
Typical Entry-Level Education	Associate's degree
Work Experience in a Related Occupation	See How to Become One
On-the-job Training	None
Number of Jobs, 2016	241,700
Job Outlook, 2016-26	13% (Faster than average)
Employment Change, 2016-26	30,300

What Radiologic and MRI Technologists Do

Radiologic technologists, also known as *radiographers*, perform diagnostic imaging examinations, such as x rays, on patients. MRI technologists operate magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) scanners to create diagnostic images.

Work Environment

Radiologic and MRI technologists work in healthcare facilities, and more than half work in hospitals.

How to Become a Radiologic or MRI Technologist

Radiologic technologists and MRI technologists typically need an associate's degree. Many MRI technologists start out as radiologic technologists and specialize later in their career. Radiologic technologists must be licensed or certified in most states. Few states license MRI technologists. Employers typically require or prefer prospective technologists to be certified even if the state does not require it.

Pay

The median annual wage for magnetic resonance imaging technologists was $71,670 in May 2018.

The median annual wage for radiologic technologists was $59,520 in May 2018.

Job Outlook

Overall employment of radiologic and MRI technologists is projected to grow 13 percent from 2016 to 2026, faster than the average for all occupations. As the population grows older, there will be an increase in medical conditions that require imaging as a tool for making diagnoses.

State & Area Data

Explore resources for employment and wages by state and area for radiologic and MRI technologists.

Similar Occupations

Compare the job duties, education, job growth, and pay of radiologic and MRI technologists with similar occupations.

More Information, Including Links to O*NET

Learn more about radiologic and MRI technologists by visiting additional resources, including O*NET, a source on key characteristics of workers and occupations.

What They Do ->

SUGGESTED CITATION:
Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Department of Labor, *Occupational Outlook Handbook*, Radiologic and MRI Technologists, on the Internet at https://www.bls.gov/ooh/healthcare/radiologic-technologists.htm (visited *August 29, 2019*).

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